

Year 4 Science - Living Things and Life Cycles

Name: _____ Date: _____

Curriculum Target

ACARA v9.0: AC9S4U01 - explore how living things grow, change and depend on their environment.

Learning Intention

I can describe stages in a life cycle and explain what living things need to survive.

Science Skill

Observe patterns, compare stages and use evidence to explain changes in living things.

Vocabulary Helper

life cycle - the stages a living thing goes through
habitat - the place where a living thing lives
survive - to stay alive and healthy

Mini Lesson - Life Cycles

Living things grow and change. A plant may begin as a seed, grow roots and leaves, flower, and make new seeds. An animal may hatch or be born, grow, become an adult, and have young of its own. Scientists compare life cycles to notice what is similar and different. For example, a frog changes from egg to tadpole to adult frog, while a eucalyptus tree grows from a seed into a mature tree. Each living thing also depends on its habitat for water, food, shelter and space.

Quick Think

Draw or write two stages in the life cycle of a plant or animal you know.

Year 4 Science - Living Things and Life Cycles

Page 2 - Science questions and investigation

Warm Up

Circle the best answer. A life cycle shows: A) weather changes B) stages of growth C) types of rocks

Write one thing a living thing needs to survive.

Build Your Skills

1. Put these frog stages in order: adult frog, egg, tadpole, young frog.
2. Explain how a seed and an adult plant are different.
3. Name one way a habitat helps a living thing survive.

Strong Challenge

Choose one Australian living thing. Write two sentences explaining its life cycle or survival needs.

★ High Five!

You noticed how living things grow and change. That is careful science thinking!

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I can describe a life cycle.
- ☐ I can compare stages.
- ☐ I can explain survival needs.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____
Next step: _____

Year 4 Science - Living Things and Life Cycles - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer

B) stages of growth. Living things may need water, food, air, shelter, sunlight or space.

Detailed answers

1. egg -> tadpole -> young frog -> adult frog.
 2. A seed is small and not yet a mature plant; an adult plant has grown and may make flowers or seeds.
 3. A habitat may provide food, water, shelter, space or protection.
- Challenge: Answers will vary. Look for a clear Australian example and science explanation.

Parent Tip - At Home

Look at a plant, pet or backyard insect. Ask, "What stage of life might it be in? What does it need today?" Keep it short and curious.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Use a quick picture sort. Students order life cycle cards, then explain their order to a partner using because.

Extension Idea

Create a small life cycle diagram for an Australian animal or plant.